KHETHI IN TECH · CAREER-CHANGE FIELD GUIDE

Your Tech Reset

A realistic route into technology that makes room for your life and the experience you already have.

You are not starting from zero.
You already know how to solve problems, work with people, manage responsibilities and learn under real-world conditions. Now connect that experience to a practical technical skill.

A free-first guide for adults exploring a move into tech
October 2026

01 · INVENTORY WHAT YOU BRING

Your previous work still counts

A career change is a bridge, not a trapdoor. Map existing strengths to a role, then add technical proof one step at a time.

People and process

Customer service can support UX research, technical support and implementation. Operations experience can support systems analysis and quality assurance.

Numbers and detail

Finance, inventory or research experience can support data analysis, reporting and data quality work.

Care and communication

Teaching, healthcare or community work can help with training, accessible design, support and translating needs into requirements.

Coordination and risk

Project coordination, compliance and administration can connect to business analysis, cybersecurity governance and technical project work.

Write your bridge sentence

“I have experience in , where I learned to . I am adding so I can contribute to .”

Choose one or two roles to investigate. Job titles vary between employers, so read the actual tasks and required skills instead of relying on the title alone.

02 · PICK A REALISTIC ENTRY PATH

Choose a role family

Technical support

Start with troubleshooting, operating systems, networking basics, ticket notes and calm communication.

Software development

Start with one language, Git, web or application basics, testing and a small finished product.

Data analysis

Start with spreadsheets, SQL, simple statistics, data cleaning and explaining a finding.

Cybersecurity

Start with networking, Linux, account security, logs and safe guided labs. Security builds on solid IT foundations.

Quality assurance

Start with test cases, bug reports, browser tools, reproducible steps and clear communication.

Systems or business analysis

Start with process mapping, requirements, APIs, databases and interviews with users.

Check the local market

1. Collect ten recent job descriptions from employers in your region or remote market.
2. Write down skills that appear repeatedly, separating essential from nice-to-have.
3. Mark skills you can already support with evidence and the gaps you can address.
4. Look for learnerships, internships and bridge programmes as well as direct roles.

Reality check: many “entry-level” jobs still ask for experience. Your project, volunteer work, previous transferable experience and well-written examples can help, but they do not guarantee an interview.

03 · LEARN AROUND REAL LIFE

A sixteen-week free-first plan

Start with four to six hours a week if that fits your schedule. If it does not, reduce the plan. It is better to keep one hour going than to resent a study timetable designed for a fictional person with no responsibilities.

Weeks 1 to 2	**Pick one role and course.** Check job descriptions, schedule two study sessions and set a learning budget of zero while exploring.
Weeks 3 to 6	**Build the fundamentals.** Follow one course. Practise each lesson. Keep a running list of terms and questions.
Weeks 7 to 10	**Make a project connected to your past work.** Analyse a public dataset, automate a repeated task, build a small site or write a safe troubleshooting guide.
Weeks 11 to 12	**Test and explain it.** Ask someone to try the project. Fix one thing. Write down the goal, limits and what you learned.
Weeks 13 to 14	**Publish a clear portfolio page.** Add screenshots or a demo, a README and honest details about your contribution.
Weeks 15 to 16	**Apply and review.** Tailor your CV to a handful of suitable roles, track responses and adjust your plan using evidence.

Free-first course starts

freeCodeCamp: https://www.freecodecamp.org/learn/

CS50: https://cs50.harvard.edu/

Microsoft Learn: https://learn.microsoft.com/training/

Free references

MDN: https://developer.mozilla.org/

Python: https://docs.python.org/3/tutorial/

Linux Journey: https://linuxjourney.com/

Certificates, exams, premium labs and some course tracks cost extra. Verify total cost, renewal terms and employer recognition before paying.

Build one project that connects both careers

Choose a project where your existing knowledge helps you ask better questions. This makes your story distinctive and the project easier to explain.

Worked in retail?

Make a sales trend dashboard from public or synthetic data. Do not use customer information from a former employer.

Worked in education?

Build a study planner or a resource directory. Explain accessibility decisions and test it with permission.

Worked in operations?

Map a repetitive process, automate a safe sample and compare time saved without exposing workplace data.

Worked in finance?

Analyse public budget data. Show your assumptions, cleaning steps and limits. Do not present an estimate as financial advice.

Short case study template

Situation: What need or question did you notice?

Action: What did you design, build or investigate?

Tools: Which technologies did you use, and why?

Result: What can someone see or do now?

Reflection: What would you improve next, and what did you learn?

CV language that stays honest

- “Built a practice project using...” rather than implying commercial production experience.
- “Currently learning...” for a course that is in progress.
- “Contributed to...” for team work, followed by the part you owned.
- Use measurable results only when you can explain how you measured them.

05 · APPLY WITHOUT BURNING OUT

Make the search a small system

Weekly routine

1. Save two or three suitable roles. Match the required tasks, not just the company name.
2. Tailor the top third of your CV and choose the most relevant project.
3. Write down the date, official link, contact, next step and response.
4. Practise a short explanation of one project and one problem you solved.
5. Take a proper break after the application session.

Protect your budget and information

☐ Use free courses and public documentation while testing your interest

☐ Set a spending cap before buying exams, subscriptions or equipment

☐ Ask whether a certificate is required, optional or simply advertised

☐ Do not pay an unverified recruiter to “secure” a job interview

☐ Do not share passwords, banking PINs or private access keys

☐ Keep family, client and employer data out of portfolio work

When progress stalls: shrink the next action. Replace “learn cybersecurity” with “read one networking lesson and write five notes”. Small steps are not a failure mode.

Your next step

One role I will investigate:

One free resource I will start:

One past skill I will carry forward:

One person I will ask for feedback:

Created by Khethi in Tech. Free learning guide, October 2026. Job requirements, course access and prices can change. Verify with the employer or course provider.

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